

Effects of Social Media on Teenage Mental Health

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Introduction

Social media has become an essential part of modern life, especially for teenagers. Platforms such as

Positive Effects of Social Media

Helps in staying connected with friends and family

Provides educational content and learning opportunities

Encourages creativity and self-expression

Builds awareness about global issues

Offers platforms for skill development and networking

Negative Effects of Social Media

Anxiety and Depression

■Constant comparison with others' lifestyles can lead to feelings of inadequacy, anxiety, and depression

Low Self-Esteem

■ Teenagers often compare their appearance, achievements, and lifestyle with influencers, which can

Addiction

■ Excessive use of social media can lead to addiction, affecting studies, sleep patterns, and daily routines.

3.4 Cyberbullying

■ Online harassment and bullying can severely damage emotional well-being and lead to stress or trauma

Sleep Disturbance

■ Late-night scrolling affects sleep quality, resulting in fatigue and poor academic performance.

Causes of Increased Impact

Lack of parental monitoring

Easy access to smartphones

Peer pressure

Algorithm-driven content addiction

Possible Solutions

Limiting daily screen time

Encouraging offline activities like sports and reading

Parental guidance and monitoring

Awareness programs in schools

Promoting positive and educational content

Conclusion

Social media is a powerful tool that can benefit teenagers if used responsibly. However, misuse and o

References

World Health Organization (WHO)

American Psychological Association (APA)

National Institute of Mental Health (NIMH)

Pew Research Center